

Invest in Ruby Open Source

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*Sponsorship
Prospectus*

2022



Gem Fellowship

Support Ruby Open Source

The Gem Fellowship is a grant partnership with **gem.coop**; the Ruby community gem server. It is supported by **Contributed Systems**; the company behind Sidekiq Pro and Sidekiq Enterprise, and **Spinel Cooperative**; the coop behind rv.

Each Fellowship provides funding to build, maintain, and improve open source tools that are freely available for anyone to use.

We funded eight projects in 2026. We would love to increase the impact of this program with support from your company.



Our 2026 Fellows



Jeanine Adkisson

Rouge was created in a fit of rage by jneen in an attic somewhere in south England when her personal website broke due to a libpython linking error in pygments.rb, which was the gold standard of syntax highlighting at the time. It has since grown into a formidable project, supporting over 200 languages and powering the syntax highlighting of Jekyll, middleman, and Gitlab among others.

codeberg.org/rouge-ruby/rouge



Emiliano Della Casa

Ruby-Asterisk is a Ruby client for the Asterisk Manager Interface (AMI) that relies on synchronous telnet connections. We are transforming it into a comprehensive toolkit for the Asterisk PBX ecosystem by adding native support for the REST Interface (ARI) and FastAGI. The project is undergoing a major architectural overhaul to leverage modern Ruby concurrency features like Ractors and Async, ensuring thread-safety and compatibility with Ruby 3 and the newest Ruby 4.

github.com/emilianodellacasa/ruby-asterisk



James Couball

ruby-git provides a Ruby interface to the git command line. The current codebase, while functional, has several design issues that have accrued over time, making it difficult to extend and maintain. The goal of this project is to refactor the codebase so it can better evolve with the git command itself.

github.com/ruby-git/ruby-git



Piotr Murach

TTY::Markdown transforms Markdown content into an easy-to-read format for display in terminal emulators. The grant will contribute to improving this experience through more robust content rendering with native hyperlinks, expanded theme configuration, greater recognition of HTML tags, and support for new elements such as emoji shortcodes or task lists.

github.com/piotrmurach/tty-markdown

Our 2026 Fellows



Christoph Olszowka

Christoph is the long-time author and maintainer of SimpleCov and Ruby Toolbox. This grant will support ongoing maintenance for his projects.

www.ruby-toolbox.com



Marco Roth

Herb is an HTML-aware ERB parser and tooling foundation that treats HTML+ERB as a structured language rather than plain text. It provides a lossless syntax tree that enables reliable formatters, linters, language servers, and more advanced rendering and developer tooling in the Ruby ecosystem.

herb-tools.dev



Dmitry Vorotilin

Ferrum and Cuprite provide a Ruby bridge to modern headless Chrome and the Capybara driver powering reliable browser-based testing. With this grant, Dmitry aims to ship Ferrum 1.0 with a stable, clean API and make Cuprite fully compatible so every Capybara test suite runs green on a fast, modern browser stack.

[Cuprite](#) [Ferrum](#)



Jared White

Bridgetown is a content-focused, “hybrid” web framework supporting both static deploys and full-stack applications. We’re ready to take things to the next level with two initiatives: an official plugin program called Bridgetown Center inspired by GNOME Circle, and a high-quality customizable theme called Willamette suitable for documentation, publishing, and portfolios.

www.bridgetownrb.com

Benefits of Sponsoring

Visibility

Reach the developers using popular open source tools.

Community Leadership

Make your company stand out by playing an active role supporting popular Ruby open source tools.

Thought Leadership

Put your brand in the right conversations by investing in the tools, developers and ideas you want to see grow in the Ruby ecosystem.

Quick Details

Fellowships exclusively support existing projects that are already popular and widely used.

Previous recipients include Herb, a newly-added part of the Ruby on Rails stack, and Rogue, the syntax highlighter used by github pages' Jekyll.

Grant applications will open December 2026, and be awarded in January 2027

A minimum of 5 different projects will be funded, in increments of \$2,500, with a maximum award of \$25,000 for a single project.

Our Headline Sponsor



Mike Perham

Early in my Ruby days, I took over maintenance on the `memcache-client` gem. A year later Couchbase asked me if I would be interested in adding support for memcache's new binary protocol; they would be willing to pay me to do the work. I accepted their offer and that work turned into the `dalli` gem which has benefited the entire Ruby community. The amount was \$3,000, a laughably small amount IMO considering the actual amount of time I spent working on it. 500-1000 hours over the next two years? But the expertise I developed from that small stipend was absolutely critical to making Sidekiq into the high performance Rubygem which has been so valuable to the Ruby community. Everybody wins.

That's the spirit in which I've created the Gem Fellowship.

Mike Perham, mike@contribsys.com

Community Impact

Without the Gem Fellowship, rouge had been floundering somewhat - I couldn't justify the amount of time and labour it took to do deeper maintenance on the project. With the Fellowship's support I was able to finally dedicate enough time to fix several major issues that I'd been putting off for over 5 years."

-Jeanine Adkison

Sponsor Options

50,000 funds 5 fellowships

bronze

\$5,000 - \$50,000

- Name mention on the 2027 sponsors list.

bronze

silver

\$50,000 - \$100,000

- Name and logo highlight in all Fellowship posts.
- Bronze Tier Benefits.

silver

gold

\$100,000+

- Name and logo as headline partner in every Fellowship post and email.
- Silver tier benefits.

gold

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The Gem Fellowship exists to improve open source tools for everyone: students, developers, startups, enterprises, and all of their users and customers. Join us to make that better world a reality, and add your company as a supporter of several widely used and beloved projects.

Reach out to andre@spinel.coop or mike@contribsys.com to talk.

We're always happy to jump on a call.

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